

KSA: Cookies, Types of Cookies, and Their Advantages

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What is a Cookie?

A **cookie** is a small piece of data stored on a user's browser by a website. It helps websites remember user information such as login status, preferences, and session activities. Cookies enhance user experience and enable smooth navigation on modern websites.

Types of Cookies:

1. Session Cookies

- Temporary and deleted when the browser is closed.
- Used for storing data during one session.

2. Persistent Cookies

- Stored for a fixed time on the user's device.
- It is useful for saving user login or settings across visits.

3. First-party Cookies

- Set by the actual website visited.
- Mainly used for functionality and user experience.

4. Third-party Cookies

- Set by other domains (usually advertisers).
- Used for ad tracking and analytics across sites.

5. Secure Cookies

- Only transmitted over HTTPS connections.
- Helps protect sensitive data from interception.

6. HTTP Only Cookies

- Cannot be accessed through JavaScript.
- Prevents certain attacks like Cross-Site Scripting (XSS).

Advantages of Cookies:

- **Authentication:** Keeps users logged in on secure websites.
- **Shopping Carts:** Remembers selected items during online shopping.
- **Personalization:** Saves language, theme, or settings preferences.
- **Analytics:** Tracks user behavior to improve site performance.
- **Efficiency:** Saves form input to avoid re-entering data.